

PRODUCT AND BUSINESS LOGIC REVIEW

Progress Invoices, Change Orders, and Contract Invoices

Revised development requirements and product review after incorporating the September 14 decision record and four follow-up rulings.

Review basis	Current React prototypes, their requirements, shared Cinderblock UI guidance, supplied screenshots and customer references, the Contract Workflows Decision Record, and Dov's follow-up rulings.
Review lens	A contractor usability and development-readiness review. Accounting implementation detail is specified only where it controls user-visible behavior or prevents inconsistent contract state.

Decision status

The earlier P0 blind spots are now resolved. This revision converts them into explicit requirements and identifies the prototype changes needed to demonstrate the settled product model.

Prepared September 14, 2026

1. Revised executive assessment

The workflow family now has a coherent product model. Progress Invoices handle tracked billing against the original Estimate; the first Accepted Change Order silently advances the contract to Contract Invoices; Standard invoice conversion is a separate, irreversible path that excludes both tracked billing and Change Orders.

The strongest improvement is that Draft no longer has ambiguous accounting meaning. A Draft reserves eligible scope, but it is excluded from Total invoiced, Previously billed, and progress until Sent. This creates a clean distinction between operational availability and recognized billing.

CONTRACTOR WORKFLOW	OVERALL UI	LOGIC READINESS
A-	A-	A-
8.9 / 10	8.7 / 10	8.8 / 10
Natural paths, strong contract context, and clear recovery rules.	Feels consistent with Cinderblock; dense contract history remains demanding.	Core cross-flow invariants are settled; prototype alignment remains.

What is now settled

- Draft invoice allocations reserve scope but do not count as billing until the invoice is Sent.
- The first Accepted CO automatically changes future tracked billing from Progress Invoice to Contract Invoice.
- CO acceptance cancels an open invoice Draft, releases its reservations, retains it read-only in the invoice table, and requires a fresh invoice against updated scope.
- Financial edits to an Accepted Estimate or CO remove acceptance and return the document to Pending; metadata remains editable and audited.
- Removed and new CO lines are independent. The prototype's replacement-pair UI and relationship state are obsolete.
- A Standard invoice conversion closes the Estimate to Progress Invoices, Contract Invoices, and Change Orders.

Remaining work is implementation alignment rather than unresolved product direction. The largest prototype mismatches are replacement grouping, Draft totals, automatic invoice routing after CO acceptance, and the status/deletion behavior described below.

2. Authoritative contract and billing model

All three experiences must project one contract ledger. Separate UI modules are appropriate; separate meanings for contract value, billing, reservations, and document status are not.

Entity	Required responsibility
Contract	Owens the original accepted Estimate, accepted CO lineage, contract value, billing mode, parties, job, currency, discount pool, and retainage parameter.
Contract document	Estimate or CO with stable identity, sequence, version, status, acceptance evidence, source context, and soft-deletion state.
Contract line	Stable source-document identity, signed quantity/value, active or removed state, fee eligibility, and audit history. No replacement relationship.
Invoice	Immutable invoice type, status, dates, source links, totals, payment state, and cancellation reason.
Invoice allocation	Maps a tracked invoice amount to an eligible contract line and has Reserved, Billed, or Released state.
Discount pool	Original Estimate discount less amounts applied by qualifying contract invoices. COs do not create or automatically recalculate it.
Audit event	Actor, timestamp, document version, action, before/after status, and material financial change.

Core calculations

- Accepted contract value = accepted Estimate total + net value of Accepted COs only.
- Total invoiced = posted value from Sent, Partially paid, and Paid tracked invoices, less allocations released by invoice cancellation. Draft is excluded.
- Reserved by Draft = active Draft allocations. This reduces scope available to another invoice but does not change Total invoiced or progress.
- Remaining billed value = accepted contract value - Total invoiced. The UI separately explains Draft reservations where availability is lower.
- Available to allocate = accepted contract value - Total invoiced - active Draft reservations, constrained by line eligibility.
- Contract progress = Total invoiced / accepted contract value. If over invoiced, the mathematical percentage may exceed 100 percent while the bar uses the established green/red normalized segments.

Cross-flow state machine

Trigger	Resulting mode	What becomes unavailable
Accepted Estimate, no invoice or CO	Choice between Standard invoice and Progress invoice; CO creation also available.	Nothing. Estimate financial fields remain editable until a dependent invoice or CO exists.
First Progress Invoice created	Estimate-only tracked billing.	Standard invoice creation is disabled.
First CO Accepted	Future tracked billing automatically routes to Contract Invoice.	Progress Invoice entry disappears. Any open invoice Draft is system-canceled.
Standard invoice created	Flexible standard-invoice conversion.	Progress Invoice, Contract Invoice, and Change Order creation from that Estimate.

3. Status, editing, reservation, and deletion rules

These rules apply consistently anywhere a document can be opened, edited, accepted, canceled, or deleted.

Object / state	Financial editing	Effect on ledger	Permitted destructive action
Estimate: Accepted, no dependent invoice/CO	Allowed. Saving a financial change removes acceptance and returns the Estimate to Pending.	Accepted contract must stop using the old version until reaccepted. Preserve version/audit history.	Soft delete only after dependent payments are voided and invoices are canceled; confirmation lists cascade.
Estimate: dependent invoice or CO exists	Locked. Notes and attachments remain editable and audited.	No silent rewrite of contract or allocations.	Same prerequisite sequence, then recoverable soft-delete cascade.
CO: new/unsaved	Editable; no status or contract-history row.	No reservation or contract effect until saved.	Close discards; no Delete/Cancel command.
CO: Draft	Editable unless a Contract Invoice draw exists.	Proposed delta excluded from contract value; selected source lines reserved.	Delete allowed with confirmation.
CO: Pending	Editable subject to same lock. Financial edit requires a new pending version.	Proposed delta excluded from contract value; source lines reserved.	Delete allowed with confirmation per decision record.
CO: Accepted	Editable only until a Contract Invoice draw exists. A financial save removes acceptance and returns to Pending.	Accepted delta included until a replacement version is pending; implementation must version atomically.	Delete blocked; use a later deductive CO. Void allowed only with no invoice draws.
CO: Declined / Canceled / Void	Historical.	No accepted contract effect and no reservation.	Delete allowed.
Invoice: Draft	Editable.	Reservations only. Excluded from Previously billed, Total invoiced, and progress.	May be canceled/deleted per invoice policy.
Invoice: Sent / paid states	Tracked contract lines locked.	Allocations count in Previously billed and progress.	Payments voided first; then invoice cancellation releases allocations.

Accepted-document edit safeguard

A financial edit must never mutate the accepted version in place. Saving creates a new document version, clears its acceptance evidence, returns it to Pending, and preserves the previously accepted version in audit history. If downstream billing already exists, financial fields remain locked and this transition is unavailable.

System-canceled invoice Draft after CO acceptance

- Release every Draft allocation and discount reservation before recalculating available scope.
- Retain the canceled Draft as a read-only row in the Invoices table with its Estimate link, original values, cancellation reason, and timestamp.
- Show a clear notification that an accepted CO changed the contract and a new invoice must be started.
- Do not offer Duplicate for Progress or Contract Invoices; Duplicate remains a Standard-invoice action only.

4. Progress Invoice requirements

Purpose: tracked billing against an Accepted Estimate before the first Accepted Change Order.

ID	Requirement
PI-01	An uninvoiced Accepted Estimate opens What type of invoice? with Standard invoice and Progress invoice.
PI-02	The first Progress Invoice offers Percent or amount and Select items. Subsequent draws also offer The rest of this estimate.
PI-03	Percent applies across eligible remaining lines; dollar amount distributes across eligible scope; selected items bill their full remaining eligible amount.
PI-04	Every Estimate line remains visible in the editor. Columns are Item, Qty, Contract Amount, Previously billed, This invoice, and percent Complete.
PI-05	Draft save creates reservations only. The Estimate shows Total invoiced from posted invoices and separately shows the amount reserved by the Draft.
PI-06	Only one Draft tracked invoice may reserve contract scope at a time. Fully billed or reserved lines cannot be allocated again.
PI-07	Sending promotes reservations to billed allocations atomically; Previously billed and progress then update.
PI-08	Canceling unsaved work creates no reservations. Canceling a posted invoice releases allocations only after payments are voided.
PI-09	The original Estimate discount is a contract pool, suggested proportionally at invoice creation, editable down to zero, and never double-reserved.
PI-10	A deposit/prepayment is the first Progress Invoice draw using Percent or amount. The contractor may enter either a percentage or dollar deposit.
PI-11	Saving keeps the user on the saved Draft invoice with its ID and entered values. Customer previews project from the same invoice state.
PI-12	Once a Progress Invoice exists, Standard invoice creation is disabled. When the first CO is Accepted, future creation routes to Contract Invoice.

Discount, tax, fee, and retainage

- Tax is computed fresh on each invoice; a contract-level tax total is not carried forward as authority.
- Cost Plus is fee-inclusive in contract value, calculated from eligible marked-up lines on each draw, and is High Rise only.
- Retainage is deferred from v1. Store a contract-level percentage defaulting to zero and parameterize calculations; do not expose UI until the separate retainage prototype is approved.
- Stored materials are outside product scope.

Contractor grade: A- (9.0/10). The flow now matches common draw behavior and explains Draft reservation without overstating billing. The main usability dependency is making the automatic Contract Invoice transition feel seamless after a CO is accepted.

5. Change Order requirements

Purpose: preserve the original contract while recording sequential additive or deductive contract adjustments.

ID	Requirement
CO-01	Create change order is available only from accepted contract context with no Draft/Pending CO and no Standard invoice conversion.
CO-02	Only one open Draft/Pending CO may exist per contract. Source selection may begin from the Estimate or the Accepted CO currently being viewed.
CO-03	Selected source lines become locked negative-quantity adjustments with original positive Cost, Markup, and Price.
CO-04	New scope is added independently with normal Estimate-style lines. Remove Add replacement item, grouped replacement UX, and replacement relationship state.
CO-05	Addition-only, removal-only, mixed, and real net-zero COs are valid. A blank or zero-value-only CO cannot be saved or sent.
CO-06	A source line already reserved by a Draft/Pending CO or removed by an Accepted CO is unavailable to another CO. Released Declined/Canceled/Void/Delete states restore eligibility.
CO-07	Save creates Draft; Send creates Pending. The status badge exposes Accept and Decline; Decline may remain nonfunctional in the v1 prototype.
CO-08	Acceptance stores actor, timestamp, and document version, adds the net delta to contract value, and automatically switches future tracked billing to Contract Invoice.
CO-09	If an invoice Draft exists, acceptance system-cancels it, releases reservations, retains a read-only invoice-table record, and notifies the contractor.
CO-10	Draft, Pending, Declined, Canceled, and Void COs can be deleted with confirmation. Accepted CO deletion is blocked.
CO-11	Accepted status may be changed to Void only when no invoice draw exists; otherwise show Cancel or delete linked invoices to update this status.
CO-12	Partial quantity reduction is remove original line plus add an independent line at the corrected quantity.

Contract summary and details

- Contract summary answers where the contract stands: accepted value, Total invoiced, Remaining or Over invoiced, and progress.
- Contract details explains lineage: original Estimate, sequential CO deltas and non-Accepted statuses, then Current contract.
- Draft/Pending delta appears as subordinate proposed context but does not change accepted metrics.
- Over invoiced is informational. Existing invoices remain unchanged. Mathematical progress may exceed 100 percent; the bar uses green accepted-contract and red overage segments normalized to Total invoiced.

Contractor grade: A- (8.8/10). The independent adjustment model is easier to understand and audit than replacement pairing.

Approval evidence, source eligibility, and over-invoiced treatment are now defined well enough for development review.

6. Contract Invoice requirements

Purpose: tracked billing across the complete accepted contract after the first Accepted Change Order. The route changes automatically; the contractor still experiences one Create invoice action.

ID	Requirement
CI-01	Accepted contract scope is the original Estimate plus Accepted CO adjustments. Draft/Pending/Declined/Canceled/Void COs are excluded.
CI-02	Creation supports The rest of this contract, Percent or amount, and Select contract items using only current eligible billing scope.
CI-03	Removed original items and negative CO adjustments are hidden from selection; fully invoiced current scope may remain visible but disabled.
CI-04	The editor groups complete history by Estimate/CO source and repeats compact column headers under each source heading.
CI-05	Internal columns are Item, Qty, Contract, Previously billed, and This invoice. Contract-level progress is authoritative.
CI-06	Removed original lines retain their historical billing and are non-billable. Negative adjustment lines use em dashes for billing fields.
CI-07	Draft values reserve eligible scope without entering Previously billed or contract progress. The editor separately surfaces reserved value.
CI-08	Saving remains on the newly assigned Draft invoice. Sending promotes allocations and updates all contract projections atomically.
CI-09	Customer PDF-style and web previews retain line percent Complete plus a separate Contract progress block; invoice totals appear first.
CI-10	Cost Plus, discount, tax, cancellation, over-invoicing, and retainage parameters follow the shared contract rules.

Customer-facing reconciliation rules

- Show all source-document sections and contract lines needed to explain cumulative billing; zero-current rows may be subdued.
- An original line removed by a CO remains readable with Removed by CO text and its actual historical billing.
- The matching negative CO adjustment is struck through, non-billable, and shows em dashes for Previously billed, This invoice, and percent Complete.
- Line percent Complete and overall Contract percent are intentionally distinct. An adjusted current line may remain below 100 percent while the whole contract is fully billed.

Contractor grade: A- (8.7/10). Source grouping and contract-level progress provide a credible way to bill revised contracts. The automatic route removes terminology decisions from the contractor, but the interface must clearly announce that accepted changes are included.

7. Cross-flow requirements and failure-safe behavior

ID	Requirement / invariant	Failure if omitted
XF-01	One contract ledger owns accepted value, posted allocations, Draft reservations, discount balance, and active billing mode.	Totals and eligibility drift across Estimate, CO, and invoice screens.
XF-02	Status transitions and allocation changes commit atomically.	A send/cancel/accept action can partially update billing.
XF-03	Every line and document uses stable IDs and versions.	Renames, reorderings, and CO changes can attach history to the wrong line.
XF-04	A financial edit to an accepted unlocked document creates a new Pending version and invalidates prior acceptance.	Customers are bound to content they did not accept.
XF-05	CO acceptance cancels open tracked Draft before new contract scope becomes invoice-eligible.	The Draft references stale scope or double-reserves value.
XF-06	Creating a Standard invoice sets the Estimate billing mode to Standard-converted and disables CO/tracked entry.	Untracked and tracked billing coexist against one source.
XF-07	Invoice cancellation requires payments voided first, releases allocations, recalculates history, and marks customer link Cancelled.	Paid value disappears or remains counted incorrectly.
XF-08	Destructive actions are idempotent and leave an audit event.	Retries duplicate release or deletion effects.
XF-09	Permissions use the existing Finances permission across all contract workflows.	Users see different authorization semantics between modules.
XF-10	All calculations are currency-safe and retainage-parameterized even while retainage UI is hidden.	Later retainage support requires formula replacement.

Estimate deletion sequence

The approved rule is recoverable cascade deletion, but it must respect invoice cancellation prerequisites. If payments exist, void them first. Cancel linked invoices next so allocations release. Then soft-delete the Estimate, its CO lineage, and related inactive records in one recoverable operation. The confirmation must enumerate the affected documents before execution.

Recommended display semantics

Value	Meaning
\$0.00	Billable field is applicable, but no amount has been billed or entered.
Positive amount	Actual posted or current value, based on the column context.
Em dash	Billing is not applicable, such as a negative CO adjustment.
Reserved by Draft	Operational hold only; excluded from Total invoiced and progress.
Pending CO delta	Proposed contract change only; excluded from accepted contract value.

8. Prototype alignment report

The current prototypes remain valuable design artifacts, but several screens and local-state rules now conflict with the approved decisions. These are prototype gaps, not unresolved business rules.

Priority	Prototype change required	Affected surface
P0	Remove Add replacement item, replacement grouping, replacementForLineId, and all replacement-copy requirements. New CO lines are independent.	Change Orders editor, model, docs, scenario checks.
P0	Separate Draft reservations from Total invoiced and Previously billed. Add explicit reserved-by-Draft context without inflating progress.	Progress Invoice and Contract Invoice Estimate summaries, models, selectors.
P0	On first CO acceptance, route future Create invoice actions to Contract Invoice automatically.	Estimate actions and shared contract state.
P0	When CO is accepted with an open tracked Draft, release reservations, mark Draft system-canceled/read-only, retain table/link history, and notify.	CO status flow, invoice table state, Estimate links.
P0	Disable both CO and tracked invoice entry after Standard invoice conversion.	Progress Invoice Estimate action state and Change Order launcher eligibility.
P1	Make Draft/Pending CO status badge actionable with Accept and visible nonfunctional Decline for v1. Store acceptance evidence in mock state.	Change Order editor header/status control.
P1	Align deletion menus: Pending and closed non-Accepted COs are deletable; Accepted is not.	Change Order overflow and confirmation flows.
P1	Return accepted financial edits to Pending; lock them once an invoice/CO dependency exists.	Estimate and CO editors.
P1	Keep system-canceled invoice Draft visible read-only and linked to its Estimate.	Invoice list/mock history and navigation.
P2	Keep retainage hidden at zero while making mock calculations parameter-ready; defer full UX to a separate prototype.	Models/docs only for current sandbox.

Documentation corrections

- Replace Change Orders documentation that defines optional replacement coupling with independent addition/removal rules.
- Replace any text that counts saved Draft as Total invoiced or Previously billed with reservation-only semantics.
- Document the automatic Progress-to-Contract Invoice transition and Standard-conversion lockout as mutually exclusive billing modes.
- Change Pending CO lifecycle text from Cancel-only to deletion allowed with confirmation, consistent with the decision record.
- Clarify that deposits may be entered by percentage or dollar amount in the existing Percent or amount control.

9. Blind-spot audit after decisions

No remaining issue blocks product review. The following are implementation details that should be made explicit in development tickets and acceptance tests so settled behavior does not fragment across modules.

Area	Development requirement	Risk level
Accepted edit/versioning	Define the atomic sequence that withdraws acceptance, creates the Pending version, and recalculates contract eligibility without losing the accepted audit record.	High
Reservation ledger	Represent Draft allocations and discount holds separately from posted billing. Release exactly once on delete, cancel, or CO-triggered cancellation.	High
Billing-mode gate	Persist Standard, Progress, or Contract mode at the contract/Estimate level; derive all entry actions from it.	High
CO acceptance transaction	Cancel open Draft, release holds, accept CO, recalculate contract, switch billing mode, and notify as one recoverable operation.	High
Deletion orchestration	Estimate cascade must check/void payments, cancel invoices, release allocations, and soft-delete linked documents in dependency order.	High
Status naming	Choose one stored/display vocabulary for Pending/Awaiting response and Canceled/Cancelled; map legacy values deliberately.	Medium
Fee/tax/discount basis	Record the exact eligible subtotal used by each calculation even though prototype arithmetic is approximate.	Medium
Customer document version	A sent/accepted link must render the issued document version, not mutable current editor state.	High
Over-invoice display	Use mathematical progress above 100 percent with normalized green/red bar segments; do not rely on a fill width over 100 percent.	Medium
Tier enforcement	Gate Cost Plus and future retainage at both UI and service layers for High Rise; base workflows remain all-tier.	Medium

Explicitly deferred

- Retainage UX (separate prototype; data model prepared only).
- Mobile experiences.
- Reporting, search, and export.
- Stored-material billing.
- Automated over-invoice recovery, credits, refunds, or reconciliation.
- QBO synchronization beyond existing product policy.

10. Contractor and UI evaluation

Contractor perspective

Grade: A- (8.9/10). The product now mirrors the main mental model used in contract work: an accepted scope, sequential authorized changes, and draws against the current accepted contract. The strongest choices are the automatic move to Contract Invoices after an accepted CO, reservation-only Drafts, clear negative adjustments, and preserving canceled Draft history without treating it as billing.

Strength	Why it works in the field
One Create invoice path	The contractor does not need to decide whether a changed contract requires a different invoice type.
Visible contract lineage	Estimate and CO source grouping makes scope changes explainable during customer disputes.
Reservation-only Draft	A preparer can hold scope without overstating earned or issued billing.
Independent CO additions	Matches how contractors document adds and deductions without forced pairings.
Historical cancellation	Keeps a traceable Draft record while allowing a clean restart after contract change.

Overall UI perspective

Grade: A- (8.7/10). The editors, status treatments, plain-text document actions, Contract summary, Contract details, and customer previews feel like extensions of Cinderblock. The main visual burden is density: grouped contract tables and parallel contract/invoice totals require disciplined spacing and hierarchy.

Improve next	Specific direction
Draft reservation clarity	Place a quiet Reserved by draft line near available scope and link it to the Draft; keep recognized billing metrics unchanged.
Automatic transition feedback	After CO acceptance, confirm that future invoices include accepted changes without introducing a new choice or product term.
Dense contract tables	Keep source headers strong, repeat compact column headers, align numeric columns, and preserve subdued historical rows.
Status menus	Make the badge affordance discoverable while keeping destructive actions in overflow confirmations.
Customer hierarchy	Lead with invoice amount and totals; contract progress and historical context remain secondary but complete.

11. Recommended development sequence

Phase	Deliverable	Exit condition
1. Domain foundation	Contract, document/version, line, invoice, allocation/reservation, discount, audit, billing-mode entities.	All core calculations have one source and deterministic fixtures.
2. State transitions	Send/post, accept, edit-to-Pending, cancel, delete, void, payment prerequisite, reservation release.	Transition matrix and idempotency tests pass.
3. Progress billing	Estimate-only creation, Draft reservation, send, previews, discount pool, one-Draft rule.	A full first/subsequent draw lifecycle reconciles.
4. Change Orders	Independent adjustment editor, approval evidence, eligibility, contract calculation, deletion/status flows.	Positive/deductive/net-zero and acceptance collision scenarios pass.
5. Contract Invoice	Automatic routing, full-contract allocation, grouped editor, customer reconciliation, over-invoice state.	Historical plus current contract totals reconcile on all surfaces.
6. Hardening	Permissions, tier gates, audit UI, document snapshots, recovery, accessibility, performance.	Pilot checklist and cross-surface regression suite pass.

Minimum review scenarios

- 1. First 25 percent Progress Invoice: save Draft, confirm reservation only, send, then confirm posted progress.
- 2. Accept a positive CO with no invoice Draft; confirm contract value rises and future Create invoice opens Contract Invoice.
- 3. Accept a deductive CO while an invoice Draft exists; confirm system cancellation, read-only table history, released scope, notification, and fresh creation.
- 4. Create a Standard invoice from an uninvoiced Estimate; confirm Progress Invoice and CO actions are no longer available.
- 5. Edit an Accepted Estimate before dependencies; confirm it returns to Pending and old acceptance evidence remains in history.
- 6. Attempt financial edit after dependent invoice/CO; confirm fields are locked while metadata remains editable.
- 7. Delete Pending and closed non-Accepted COs; confirm source eligibility and contract value remain correct.
- 8. Cancel an invoice after voiding payments; confirm allocations release and customer link displays Cancelled.
- 9. Accept a deductive CO below Total invoiced; confirm informational over-invoiced amount, percentage above 100, and normalized green/red bar.

12. Decision traceability and review checklist

Applied decisions

Decision	Result in this report
D1	Draft is reservation-only; posted billing begins at Sent.
D2	First Accepted CO automatically selects Contract Invoice for future tracked billing.
D3 + follow-up	Open Draft is system-canceled, retained read-only in invoice table, remains linked to Estimate, and must be recreated.
D4/D9 + follow-up	Accepted financial edit returns to Pending; dependency-based locks remain.
D5	Replacement coupling is removed.
D6	Estimate-style manual/customer acceptance; prototype status menu exposes Accept/Decline.
D7/D8 + follow-up	CO deletion by status; Estimate soft-delete follows payment-void and invoice-cancel prerequisites.
D10	Accepted CO status transitions follow Estimate pattern with draw-dependent Void rule.
D11-D15	Retainage deferred/data-ready; deposits use first draw; stored materials excluded; quantity correction is remove/re-add; fee/tax/discount rules set.
D16 + follow-up	Billing modes are exclusive; Standard conversion also disables CO creation.
D17-D21	Over-invoice informational; cancellation releases; existing permissions; mobile/reporting deferred.

Development review checklist

- Can every displayed dollar amount be traced to accepted contract lines, posted invoice allocations, or a clearly labeled Draft reservation?
- Does every entry action derive from the stored billing mode and accepted CO state?
- Can no accepted document be financially changed without a new Pending version and preserved acceptance evidence?
- Can a retry of cancel/delete/accept release or apply value more than once?
- Do internal editors, Estimate/CO summaries, and customer views reconcile to the same ledger snapshot?
- Are Standard, Progress, and Contract invoices immutable types for their full lifecycle?
- Do all destructive flows preserve auditability, payment prerequisites, and recoverability where required?

Readiness conclusion

The product direction is ready for formal development review. The decision set resolves the earlier blocking conflicts and supports one coherent contract-billing architecture. Development should begin with the ledger and transition rules, then bring the prototypes into alignment before using them as acceptance references.